IBM 6400 G3 Final Group Project
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Executive Interview: **Boiling Point**

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Current Role & Responsibilities

- Develop and execute marketing strategies for multi-location brand growth
- Create promotional campaigns and manage social media content
- Oversee influencer marketing: partnerships, performance tracking, and ROI measurement
- Manage digital advertising, website updates, and customer communications

COMPANY OVERVIEW

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Mission & Value

- Provide comforting, convenient individual hot soup experiences
- Combine authentic flavors with speed and customization

Target Customers

- Asian American consumers and families in Southern California
- Value consistency, comfort, and convenience
- Strong multi-generational loyalty (20+ years)

Competitive Positioning

- Pioneer Taiwanese hot pot brand in SoCal
- Combines traditional appeal with continuous menu innovation

Industry Overview

- Fast casual dining industry
- Growth of Asian food/hot pot in the U.S.
- Highly saturated market (especially in SoCal)
- Competition is increasing from both traditional restaurants + trendy brands

Evolution of Digital Marketing

Major Shift

- Shift from polished, brand-produced content → authentic, creator-driven content
- Rise of influencer marketing and short-form video

Customer Behavior Changes

- Discovery now happens through social media (not traditional ads)
- Customers research online before visiting
- Higher expectations for frequent, real-time content

What No Longer Works

- Overly polished, scripted brand content
- Traditional formal advertising styles

Digital Marketing Pivots

Strategic Adjustments

- Post-COVID shift to digital-first marketing
- Promoted online ordering, app-based offers & loyalty incentives
- Value-based promotions & combo deals to address inflation concerns
- Increased social media & influencer content frequency as customers spent more time online

New Channels, Tools, Technology

- Instagram & TikTok
  - short-form video
- Influencer tracking tools & unique promo codes
- Analytics platforms to evaluate reach, engagement & conversions
- AI tools adopted for brainstorming, drafting copy & organizing content

What Content Works Best Today

Short-Form Video

- ❑ Steam, soup pouring & food pulls perform best

→ **Highly visual & scroll-stopping**

→ **Drives engagement on Instagram & TikTok**

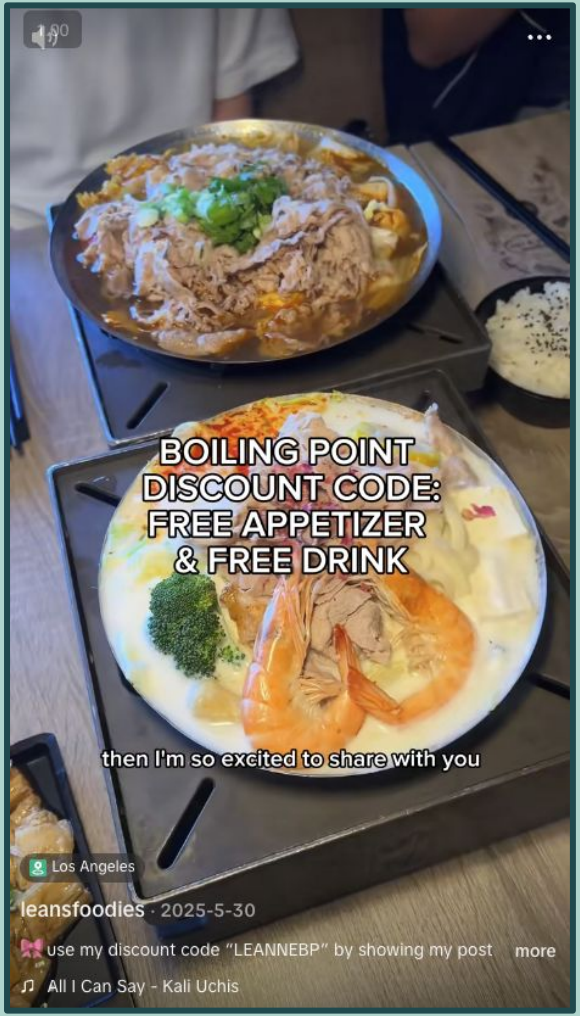
Seasonal Campaigns

- ❑ Limited-time menu items & holiday specials
- ❑ Birthday promos & brand collaborations

→ **Creates urgency & drives repeat visits**

Over-Produced Content

- ❑ Polished, scripted posts are less effective today
- ❑ Customers prefer real & casual content
- ❑ Behind-the-scenes style outperforms formal ads



Successful Campaign Example

- Personalized Promo Codes
  - "LEANNEBP"
- Influencer-specific Tracking + Surveys
- Authentic Dining Experience Content

RESULTS:

- Increased Engagement & Awareness
- Generated Measurable Revenue
- Helped Identify High-performing Creators

Bottom Line: Authenticity Converted Better Than Polished, Professional Ads

BIG FOLLOWERS ≠ BIG RESULTS

THE BIG INFLUENCER

1M+ FOLLOWERS

- 1,200,000 FOLLOWERS
- 500,000 VIEWS
- 8,000 LIKES
- 150 CLICKS
- 12 REDEMPTIONS
- LOW SALES

LOTS OF VIEWS, BUT NOT MUCH SOUP SOLD. 😢

THE MICRO-INFLUENCER

1K – 10K FOLLOWERS

- 8,500 FOLLOWERS
- 80,000 VIEWS
- 12,000 LIKES
- 2,300 CLICKS
- 680 REDEMPTIONS
- HIGH SALES!

FEWER FOLLOWERS, BUT WAY MORE CUSTOMER ACTION!

LESSONS LEARNED:

ENGAGEMENT MATTERS MORE THAN FOLLOWER COUNT.

Just because you have a lot of followers, it does NOT mean you'll get a lot of engagement!

OWERS ≠ BIG RESULTS

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In this day and age, authenticity and emotional storytelling is the KEY.

Successful Campaign Example #2

- ❑ The Promo: Free Birthday Hot Pot Soup Entrée

Why Does This Work?

- ❑ Encourages Repeat Visits
- ❑ Customers Often Come in Large Groups
- ❑ Increases Total Check Size

Additional Positive Effects

- ❑ Generates More Organic Social Content Online
- ❑ Brings in New/Existing Customers Without Extra Ad Spend
- ❑ Core Memories -> See Picture on Right

Role of Digital Marketing in the Industry

"Over time, Boiling Point has shifted **from depending mostly on word-of-mouth** and in-store experiences **to focusing much more heavily on digital marketing.**"

Stay relevant and continue reaching new audiences

Relying only on returning customers is not enough in today's market.

Respond more quickly to trends

Connect with younger audiences who may not already be familiar with the brand.

Promote limited-time products

Now use social media, influencer partnerships, online advertising, website content, email marketing, and app-based promotions

Core Digital Marketing Channels

Instagram

- Over **20,000 followers**
- Where customers first see new **product launches, seasonal campaigns**, promotions, and **brand collaborations**

Influencer partnerships

- Food creators, lifestyle influencers, and local content creators
- New audiences and create **authentic content** around the brand

Content Marketing

- Promote new menu items, limited-time offers, store openings, and special events
- Keep customers engaged with **content that is visually appealing,** timely, and relevant

Current Priorities & KPIs

Campaigns should not only generate attention but also **drive measurable business results**

REACH & IMPRESSIONS

Did we reach new, relevant audiences at a meaningful frequency?

01

TRAFFIC & ENGAGEMENT

Did we drive meaningful traffic to our website/app?

Did the campaign help increase followers or engagement (CTR, View %) on our social channels?

02

CODE REDEMPTIONS

How many customers used a creator's promo code?

How much revenue was generated?

03

RETURN ON INVESTMENT

What is the ROI when all partnership and promotional costs are taken into account?

04

“AI can help speed up the creative process and improve efficiency, but it **cannot fully replace human creativity**.”

“We want to make sure our content feels **authentic, relevant, and genuinely connected** to the Asian-American community.”

Advice for Aspiring Digital Marketers

- Balance creativity + data
- Stay curious and adaptable
- Understand customer behavior and performance metrics
- Gain hands-on experience (internships, projects, content creation)
- **Digital marketing requires both creative thinking and analytical decision-making.**

Thank you !

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